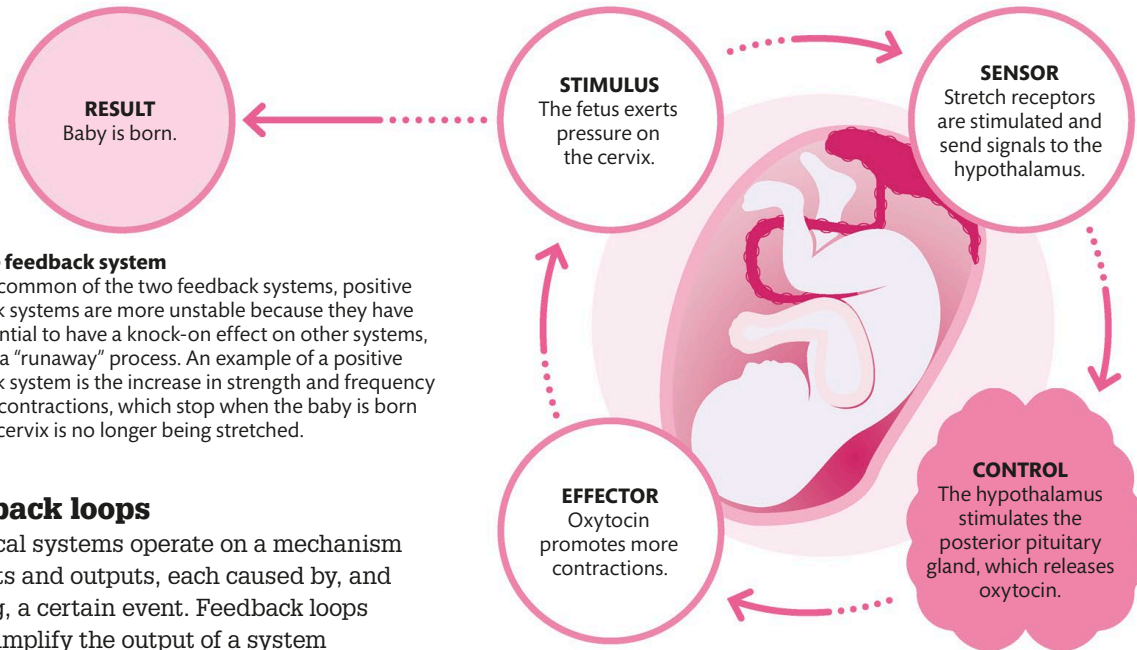


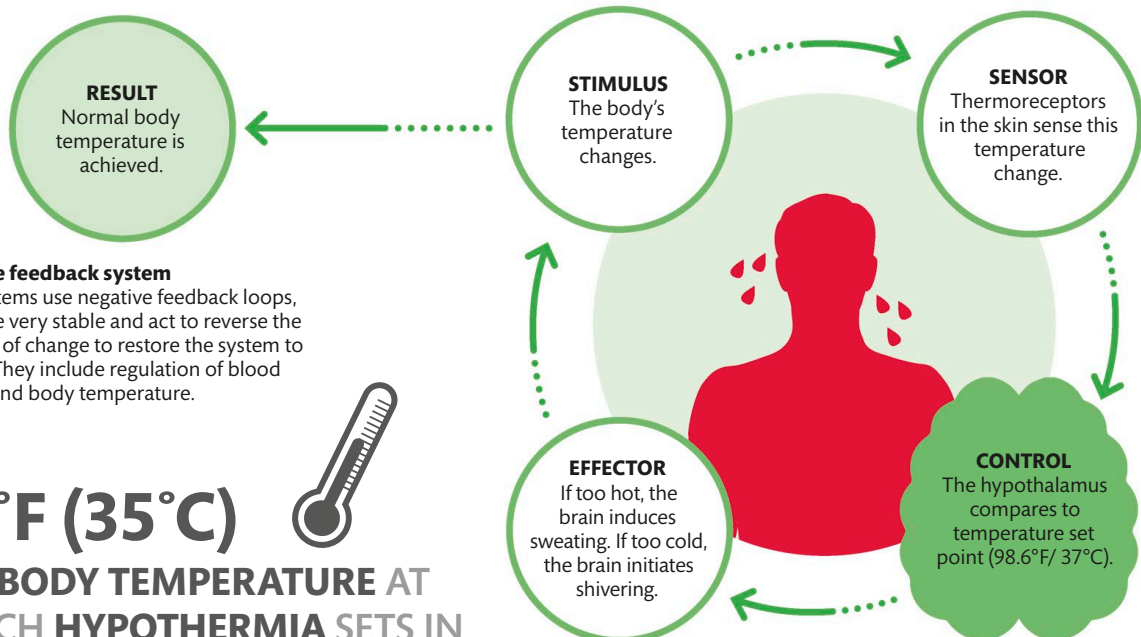


Positive feedback system

The less common of the two feedback systems, positive feedback systems are more unstable because they have the potential to have a knock-on effect on other systems, creating a "runaway" process. An example of a positive feedback system is the increase in strength and frequency of labor contractions, which stop when the baby is born and the cervix is no longer being stretched.

Feedback loops

Biological systems operate on a mechanism of inputs and outputs, each caused by, and causing, a certain event. Feedback loops either amplify the output of a system (positive feedback) or inhibit the output of the system (negative feedback). Feedback loops are important because they allow living organisms to maintain homeostasis.



Negative feedback system

Most systems use negative feedback loops, which are very stable and act to reverse the direction of change to restore the system to normal. They include regulation of blood glucose and body temperature.



95°F (35°C)

THE BODY TEMPERATURE AT WHICH HYPOTHERMIA SETS IN